Strong 2-♣ Opening

Open 2♣ on any hand containing 22 or more points.
OR, open 2♣ with a hand containing 19-21 points and with 9+ playing tricks.

There are several methods of responding. For these Deals use the 2♦ Negative for all hands with 7 or fewer points. Any other response shows 8 or more points.

The 2♣ bid is artificial; Opener's second bid describes her hand.
2NT shows a balanced 22-24 point hand
3NT shows a balanced 25-27 point hand
2 of a suit shows a 5-card or longer suit

With a very weak hand (0-3 points) Responder should bid the "second negative" at his second turn. This is usually 3♣, but if Opener bids 3♣ then it is 3♦. If Opener should bid 3♦ at his second turn the second negative bid is 3♥.

Later bidding depends on the partnership, but unless particular conventions are in use then later bidding is natural.

Board: 1
Dealer: **South**

Contract: 6♥
Declarer: North
Lead: ♠J

Board: 2
Dealer: **West**

Contract: 7♠
Declarer: East
Lead: ♥3

Board: 3
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♠
Declarer: South
Lead: ♣A

Board: 4
Dealer: **East**

Contract: 3NT
Declarer: West
Lead: ♠7

Board: 5
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♥
Declarer: North
Lead: ♠4

Board: 6
Dealer: **West**

Contract: 6NT
Declarer: East
Lead: ♥4

Board 1
South Deals
None Vul

	♠ 4 2 ♥ Q J 9 7 5 ♦ A 5 2 ♣ 7 5 3	
♠ Q 9 5 ♥ 6 3 ♦ 10 8 7 ♣ A J 10 9 2	N W E S	♠ J 10 8 7 ♥ 10 4 ♦ 9 6 4 3 ♣ 8 6 4
	♠ A K 6 3 ♥ A K 8 2 ♦ K Q J ♣ K Q	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			2♣
Pass	2♥	Pass	4NT[1]
Pass	5♦[2]	Pass	6♥
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 1 ace

6♥ by North
Lead: ♠J

SOUTH has a nice 2♣ opening hand.

With 8 points, NORTH can make a positive response so he bids his 5-card ♥suit.

SOUTH likes ♥s, knows there are at least 33 points, but needs to make sure the opponents don't have two Aces so she uses Blackwood.

When NORTH shows one Ace SOUTH bids 6♥.

Board 2
West Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ 7 4 ♥ 8 4 ♦ 9 8 4 3 ♣ Q 10 9 6 5	
♠ K Q 10 2 ♥ A Q J 10 5 ♦ A K 2 ♣ K		♠ A J 9 8 3 ♥ K 7 2 ♦ 6 ♣ A 8 7 4
	♠ 6 5 ♥ 9 6 3 ♦ Q J 10 7 5 ♣ J 3 2	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
2♣	Pass	2♠	Pass
3♠	Pass	4♣	Pass
4♦	Pass	4NT[1]	Pass
5♠[2]	Pass	7♠	
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 3 aces

7♠ by East
Lead: ♥3

WEST opens 2♣ and is pleased when EAST makes a positive response of 2♠. His first step is to set the trump suit by bidding 3♠. There is NO chance that EAST will pass.

EAST now bids 4♣ a Control-showing bid. WEST continues Control-showing with 4♦.

That's enough for EAST to hear. She invokes Blackwood and learning they have all the Aces bids 7♠.

Board 3
North Deals
None Vul

♠ K Q 8 6
♥ A K J 2
♦ A K Q
♣ 8 6

♠ 4 3
♥ Q 6 4
♦ J 9 4
♣ A J 9 7 4



♠ 9 5
♥ 10 5 3
♦ 10 7 6 5 3
♣ K 10 2

♠ A J 10 7 2
♥ 9 8 7
♦ 8 2
♣ Q 5 3

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	2♣	Pass	2♠
Pass	3♠	Pass	4♠
All Pass			

4♠ by South
Lead: ♣A

NORTH has a minimum 2♣ opening.

SOUTH, with 8 points and a 5-card suit, should make a positive response, 2♠.

NORTH shows the ♠ support first, to set the trump suit, and to give SOUTH an opportunity for a move toward slam if he wants to do so.

SOUTH would now make a Control-showing bid IF HE HAD A CONTROL. Since he doesn't he just returns to 4♠ which NORTH passes.

Board 4
East Deals
Both Vul

♠ J 10 8 7 5
♥ J 7 6
♦ 10 9 5
♣ 8 6

♠ K 6 3
♥ Q 8 5
♦ K 7 6 4
♣ 9 5 3



♠ A Q 9
♥ A K 2
♦ A 8 3
♣ A J 7 4

♠ 4 2
♥ 10 9 4 3
♦ Q J 2
♣ K Q 10 2

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		2♣	Pass
2NT	Pass	3NT	
All Pass			

3NT by West
Lead: ♠7

EAST, with 22 points and balanced, opens 2♣, expecting to rebid 2NT.

But WEST responds a positive 2NT, showing a balanced hand with 8 or more points.

EAST bids what his hand is worth, 3NT and WEST passes.

Board 5
North Deals
None Vul

	♠ A K 9 ♥ A J 8 2 ♦ A 6 ♣ A K 9 3	
♠ 10 8 3 ♥ K ♦ K 10 8 5 4 3 ♣ Q 10 2		♠ 6 5 4 ♥ 9 6 4 3 ♦ Q J 9 ♣ J 7 6
	♠ Q J 7 2 ♥ Q 10 7 5 ♦ 7 2 ♣ 8 5 4	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	2♣	Pass	2♦
Pass	2NT	Pass	3♣
Pass	3♥	Pass	4♥
All Pass			

4♥ by North
Lead: ♠4

NORTH opens 2♣ and SOUTH responds 2♦ showing fewer than 8 points.

NORTH bids 2NT with a 23 point balanced hand.

SOUTH has enough points to bid 3NT, but with two 4-card Major suits bids 3♣ Stayman instead. NORTH won't confuse this as the second negative since that bid isn't used after a 2NT rebid.

So NORTH shows her 4-card ♥ suit and SOUTH bids 4♥.

Board 6
West Deals
E-W Vul

♠ 5 4 2
♥ J 10 9 7 6
♦ 2
♣ 10 8 5 2

♠ A K 9
♥ A K 2
♦ A 8 3
♣ A Q 7 4



♠ Q 6 3
♥ Q 8 5
♦ K 7 6 4
♣ K J 3

♠ J 10 8 7
♥ 4 3
♦ Q J 10 9 5
♣ 9 6

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
2♣	Pass	2NT	Pass
3NT	Pass	6NT	
All Pass			

6NT by East
Lead: ♥4

EAST has a balanced hand with 11 points, so she responds 2NT to WEST's 2♣ opening bid.

WEST bids 3NT. This shows 22-24 points, a hand he was planning to rebid 2NT.

EAST knows the side has at least 33 points, but no more than 35 so she bids 6NT.